Module 2: Basic Prompt Engineering

Key Frameworks for EMs

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Session Objective

By the end of this module, the Engagement Manager will be able to:
1. Stop communicating with MS Copilot as if it were a search engine. 2. Structure robust prompts using the **5 Pillars Framework**. 3. Apply the **TAM Framework** (Task, Audience, Method) to draft precise stakeholder communications.

1. The Search Engine Fallacy

AI is not Google. It does not retrieve; it reasons (statistically).

- **Google Search:** “Capgemini change request template” (Keywords).
- **MS Copilot:** “Act as a Capgemini Delivery Executive. Draft a formal Change Request for a client who added 3 new reporting dashboards to the scope. Use a diplomatic but firm tone.” (Context + Intent).

Rule of Thumb: If your prompt is shorter than a Tweet (280 characters), you are likely under-utilizing the AI and risking hallucinations.

2. The 5 Pillars of Prompting

A vague prompt yields a useless document. Every professional prompt requires 5 pillars:
1. **Role:** Identity of the AI (e.g., Senior Engagement Manager). 2. **Context:** Objective and concrete material facts (Project status, client mood). 3. **Instruction:** The imperative verb (Analyze, Extract, Compare). 4. **Constraints:** Business limits and rules of what NOT to do. 5. **Format:** Expected output (Table, 2-page memo, bullet points).

Exercise 1: The 5 Pillars Makeover

Context: Your junior PM asked Copilot: *"Write an email asking for a meeting agenda."* The result was generic and unprofessional. **Task:** Rewrite this prompt using the 5 Pillars.

- **Draft Prompt to Try:**

"[ROLE] Act as an IT Project Manager. [CONTEXT] We have a SteerCo meeting tomorrow with the client's CIO, but they haven't sent the agenda topics yet. [INSTRUCTION] Draft a polite email requesting the agenda. [CONSTRAINTS] Do not sound accusatory; keep it under 3 paragraphs. [FORMAT] Output the email with a clear subject line."

3. The TAM Framework

For persuasive communication, structuring the *Why* is as important as the *What*.

- **T - Task:** What exactly needs to be done? (e.g., Explain a 2-week delay).
- **A - Audience:** Who is reading this? What is their technical level and emotional state? (e.g., Non-technical CFO, highly frustrated).
- **M - Method:** How should the information be delivered? (e.g., Executive summary followed by a mitigation plan).

Exercise 2: Using TAM for Difficult Emails

Context: The offshore development team missed a critical deadline. You need to inform the client's VP of Engineering without damaging the relationship. **Task:** Use the TAM framework in MS Copilot to draft the communication.

- **Draft Prompt to Try:**

I need to send an email about a missed deadline. **Task:** Explain that the offshore team was delayed by 3 days due to unexpected server downtime, but we are allocating weekend resources to catch up. **Audience:** The client's VP of Engineering (technical, results-oriented, currently frustrated). **Method:** A direct, professional email starting with the bad news, immediately followed by the mitigation plan, using bullet points for clarity.

Recap & Next Session

Today we learned:

- Stop using keywords; start providing context.
- The **5 Pillars** guarantee structured, predictable outputs.
- The **TAM Framework** tailors the message to the stakeholder's reality.

Next Session: *Module 3: Statement of Work (SOW) Analysis & Review.* We will learn how to feed long documents into Copilot to extract hidden risks, ambiguous clauses, and SLA commitments.

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